

However, manufacturers confess that the penetration level is on the lower side, which offers them a huge scope for expansion. Within the projectors segment, home projectors are growing faster, primarily owing to the demand for large-screen entertainment at home.

"The first-time buyer is looking at 720p 2D/3D projectors as the cost of these projectors has reduced drastically over the last two years," says Harish A.K., business head-visual instruments, Epson India.

The main factors that seem to be driving the growth of home projectors are full HD content, changing lifestyle, higher spending on gadgets, 3D technology and wireless connectivity.

LCD vs DLP 3D projectors

3D projectors (whether LCD or DLP) have their own set of problems, which is quite natural when a high-end technology is adopted on devices that are affordable.

As far as DLP 3D projectors are concerned, these generally cause 'rainbow effect,' i.e., reproduction of seven colours, which can be bothersome at times. These projectors are high power consuming, inflating your electricity bills. Also, DLP projectors need 30 per cent higher lumens to reach the brightness level of LCD projectors.

LCD projectors, on the other hand, are heavy and bulky. Their overall contrast levels are lower, which may result in black pixels appearing washed out.

As both DLP and LCD projectors have their own advantages and disadvantages, the choice between the two eventually boils down to your requirements and the budget, weight issues, and factors like the size of your room.

The right buy

When buying a projector, the key factors you need to consider are colour reproduction, contrast ratio, HDMI interface and 3D brightness of the projector. Also check the pricing of 3D glasses and any possible replacement.

Brightness. Make sure that the projector has enough firepower to project in a partially or fully lit room. Choose one with minimum brightness of 2000 lumens. For 3D viewing you need a projector that is capable of projecting bright images (1800 to 2500 lumens).

Portable. Today, 3D projectors have become a lot more compact and light-weight. Being portable also means that the installation and setting up of the device is easier, so it becomes convenient to try out the projector for various screen sizes and distances in order to choose the room where the projector delivers the best.

Connectivity. Connectivity options include HDMI, DVI, Video, VGA, USB, AV receivers, CEC (consumer electronics control) connection and Ethernet data connection. HDMI and USB ports, in particular, have become popular with users these days. Select a projector that offers at least these two connectivity options.

Resolution. The projector should have a minimum of 720p resolution in order to ensure the best performance from a Blu-ray player, high-definition gaming console and other high-resolution devices.

Colour reproduction. Check for natural tones and colour depth in the images produced by the projector. Also look at how colours are delivered in the brightest and darkest areas of the image. While there is no correct measure of colour reproduction as each eye has varied sense of colour perception, make sure that the content displayed suits your needs.

Contrast ratio. Contrast ratio basically complements the brightness on the display. A projector might have a high lumens rating, but if the contrast ratio is low the image will look washed out. When buying a projector, contrast ratio of 1500:1 or higher is the minimum requirement.

Glasses. 3D-compatible video source, 3D glasses and 3D content are a must for watching content on 3D projectors. Check whether the projector comes with 3D glasses (which is mostly the case).

WHAT'S AVAILABLE

BenQ GP10

The 3D-ready BenQ GP10 uses LED projection technology. It features 720p HD-ready short-throw projection, 30,000-hour LED light source, 550 ANSI lumen brightness, HDMI multimedia connectivity, USB multiple-format support for movies, pictures and music, wireless display, SD card slot, and two built-in 3W stereo speakers with SRS. GP10 also comes with optional detachable DVD player.

| Price: ₹ 59,990

